

Silent Night, Holy Night

Text: Joseph Mohr, 1818;
tr. John Freeman Young, 1863
STILLE NACHT irregular

Music: Franz Gruber, 1818

The musical score is written for a guitar and four voices (Soprano, Alto, Tenor, Bass). The guitar part is in the key of B-flat major (two flats) and 6/8 time. It features a series of chords and fingerings: Bb (3 2 1 1), F (2 1), Bb (3 2 1 1), Eb (2 3 1), Bb (3 2 1 1), Eb (2 3 1), Bb (3 2 1 1), F (2 1), Bb (3 2 1 1), and Bb (3 2 1 1). The vocal parts are arranged in four staves, each with a line of lyrics. The lyrics are in English and German. The English lyrics are: "1 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! All is calm, all is bright, Shep - herds quake at the sight, Son of God, love's pure light, Won - drous star, lend thy light, round yon vir - gin moth - er and child, ho - ly In - fant, so ten - der and mild, glo - ries stream from heav - en a - far, heav'n - ly hosts sing: 'Al - le - lu - ia, ra - diant beams from Thy ho - ly face, with the dawn of re - deem - ing grace, with the an - gels let us sing, Al - le - lu - ia to our King, sleep in heav - en - ly peace, Christ the Sav - ior is born, Je - sus, Lord, at Thy birth, Christ the Sav - ior is born." The German lyrics are: "1 Stille Nacht, heilige Nacht! Alle ist still, alle ist hell, Engeln wird nicht bang, der Herr ist in der Welt, Wie ein Kindlein wird uns geschenkt, gib uns deine Gnad, um dieses Kindleins willen, heilige Infant, so zart und mild, Glorien strömen von dem Himmel her, himmlische Heer sing: 'Alleluia, strahlende Beams von deinem Angesicht, mit der Morgenröte der Erlösung, mit den Engeln lasst uns sing, Alleluia zu deinem König, schlaf in himmlischer Friede, Christus der Erlöser ist geboren, Jesus, Herr, bei deiner Geburt, Christus der Erlöser ist geboren."

1 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! All is calm, all is bright,
2 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Shep - herds quake at the sight,
3 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Son of God, love's pure light,
4 Si - lent night, ho - ly night! Won - drous star, lend thy light,
round yon vir - gin moth - er and child, ho - ly In - fant, so ten - der and mild,
glo - ries stream from heav - en a - far, heav'n - ly hosts sing: "Al - le - lu - ia,
ra - diant beams from Thy ho - ly face, with the dawn of re - deem - ing grace,
with the an - gels let us sing, Al - le - lu - ia to our King,
sleep in heav - en - ly peace, sleep in heav - en - ly peace.
Christ the Sav - ior is born, Christ the Sav - ior is born."
Je - sus, Lord, at Thy birth, Je - sus, Lord, at Thy birth.
Christ the Sav - ior is born, Christ the Sav - ior is born.